



2025 English Extension 1 Trial Examination

General Instructions:

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 2 hours
- Write using black pen
- Write your student number at the top of every page
- Number all pages and write total pages used on front of writing booklet

Section I – 25 marks

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 60 minutes for this section
- Answer in separate writing booklet/s

Section II – 25 marks

- Attempt Question 2
- Allow about 60 minutes for this section
- Answer in separate writing booklet/s

Total marks: 50 marks

Section I: Common Module - Literary Worlds

25 marks

Attempt Question 1(a) and 1(b)

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
- craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language

Use **Text 1** and **Text 2** to answer Question 1

Text 1 – Speech

Extract from *How Should One Read a Book* - Virginia Woolf

Simple as this sounds, people are always behaving as if all books were of the same species—as if there were only tortoises or nothing but tigers. It makes them furious to find a novelist bringing Queen Victoria to the throne six months before her time; they will praise a poet enthusiastically for teaching them that a violet has four petals and a daisy almost invariably ten. You will save a great deal of time and temper better kept for worthier objects if you will try to make out before you begin to read what qualities you expect of a novelist, what of a poet, what of a biographer. The tortoise is bald and shiny; the tiger has a thick coat of yellow fur. So books too differ: one has its fur, the other has its baldness.

Yes; but for all that the problem is not so simple in a library as at the Zoölogical Gardens. Books have a great deal in common; they are always overflowing their boundaries; they are always breeding new species from unexpected matches among themselves. It is difficult to know how to approach them, to which species each belongs. But if we remember, as we turn to the bookcase, that each of these books was written by a pen which, consciously or unconsciously, tried to trace out a design, avoiding this, accepting that, adventuring the other; if we try to follow the writer in their experiment from the first word to the last, without imposing our design upon them, then we shall have a good chance of getting hold of the right end of the string.

Text 2 – Prose Fiction

Extract from *The Vaster Wilds* - Lauren Groff

On she pressed through the night. She sang the songs of her dancing-fool youth until she had come to the end of her memory and did not want to sing them all through again, then she counted her footsteps but this did not take long for she did not know in truth what came after nine hundred and ninety-nine though she understood vaguely that at some point a thousand came in. What education she had was accidental, the gleanings of talk that she had absorbed by chance and the pictures in the books that the mistress's boy Kit had showed her either to display his superior understanding or to frighten her.

Deep in the night, she saw an opening in the path and came out into a broad dim plain. It was, she understood, the second river to the north of the settlement, and the ice over the water had broken up in the thaw of the last days. The floes* struggled against each other, moaning and squealing, bringing to her mind a great pen of pigs. She knew when looking at them that there would be no crossing here by foot. She saw herself leaping, a flea, from floe to floe and laughed because she would soon slip and fall in and drown. But then she stopped laughing and wept.

For some time, she allowed herself the luxury of despair, crouching with her head cradled by her arms. When she stood again and wiped her face, she knew that there was nothing to do but move upstream to the west, away from the bay to the east, and she would follow this bank of the river until she could find a fording place* where the water became thin and shallow enough to cross.

*floe: a sheet of floating ice

*fording place: A "fording place" refers to a shallow section of a river or stream where it is possible to cross by wading through the water

Question 1

In your response to Question 1 part (a) and (b), draw on your understanding of the module Literary Worlds and the extract/s provided

a) Use **Text 1** and **Text 2** to answer part (a)

Compare how **Text 1** and **Text 2** reflect your understanding of the ways that authors construct literary worlds that “overflow their boundaries”.

Your response must include an analysis of **Text 1** and **Text 2**.

15 Marks

b) Use **Text 2** to answer part (b)

Compose a sustained imaginative response that imagines the protagonist from **Text 2** in a different setting. In your response, you must include reference to an aspect of the given extract.

10 Marks

End of Question 1

Section II: Electives

25 marks

Attempt Question 2

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas of Literary Mindscapes and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
- Craft a sustainable composition appropriate to the question demonstrating control of the use of language

Question 2: Electives - Answer ONE question from the following Electives

Elective 1: Literary Homelands (25 marks)

The mind will only be at peace when connected with the world around it

To what extent does your study of literary homelands affirm or challenge this statement? In your response you must refer to TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE related text.

The prescribed texts for Elective 1: Literary Homelands are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Aravind Adiga, *The White Tiger*
 - E M Forster, *A Passage to India*
 - Colm Tóibín, *Brooklyn*
- **Poetry**
 - Eileen Chong, *Burning Rice*

The prescribed poems are:

 - ❖ *Burning Rice*
 - ❖ *Mid-autumn Mooncakes*
 - ❖ *My Hakka Grandmother*
 - ❖ *Shophouse, Victoria Street*
 - ❖ *Chinese Ginseng*
 - ❖ *Winter Meeting*
 - ❖ *Singapore*
- **Drama**
 - Andrew Bovell, *The Secret River* [by Kate Grenville - An adaption or the stage by Andrew Bovell]

Question 2 continues on the next page

- **Film** - Sarah Gavron, *Brick Lane*

OR

Elective 2: Worlds of Upheaval (25 marks)

A world in disorder is a world in need of new truths

To what extent does your study of worlds of upheaval affirm or challenge this statement? In your response you must refer to TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE related text.

The prescribed texts for Elective 2; Worlds of Upheaval are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Elizabeth Gaskell, *North and South*
 - Mary Shelley, *Frankenstein*
 - Madeleine Thien, *Do Not Say We Have Nothing*
- **Poetry**
 - Seamus Heaney, *Opened Ground: Poems 1966-1996*

The prescribed poems are:

 - ❖ *Digging*
 - ❖ *The Strand at Lough Beg*
 - ❖ *Casualty*
 - ❖ *Funeral Rites*
 - ❖ *Whatever You Say Say Nothing*
 - ❖ *Triptych*
- **Drama**
 - Samuel Beckett, *Waiting for Godot*
- **Film**
 - Fritz Lang, *Metropolis*

OR

Elective 3: Reimagined Worlds (25 marks)

The imagination will only be stimulated when connected with the world around it

To what extent does your study of reimagined worlds affirm or challenge this statement? In your response you must refer to TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE related text.

The prescribed texts for Elective 3: Reimagined Worlds are:

Question 2 continues on the next page